

Lace & Luggage

A LOOKBOOK

Temitope Israel Balogun

Ibadan, Nigeria

Lace & Luggage

A Lookbook

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FOREWORD

Native wear, worn on the street

These are clothes I wear around Ibadan, and I put every look together myself.

Native wear and street wear usually live in separate wardrobes. In this book they share the pages. A yellow lace buba and kembe is carried with a leather cross-body bag and heavy shoes. Printed native sets are worn with chains, dark glasses and woven caps. Oversized tees, faded denim and slides get the same care.

This is a record of my style as it is now.

Temitope Israel Balogun
Ibadan

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CHAPTER ONE

Lace & Luggage

Ceremony and the street in one outfit

Lace is what we wear to celebrate. A bag and heavy shoes are what we carry through the street. This chapter is native wear: lace, printed sets and plain bright colours, with woven caps, chains and dark glasses.



LOOK 1 · YELLOW LACE

Yellow lace buba and kembe with a gold and green cap, Louis Vuitton-branded sunglasses, socks and chunky black patent shoes, and a Gucci-branded black leather cross-body bag. Photographed by Tynemoore.



LOOK 2 · PURPLE SET

Purple native set with a striped woven cap, evil-eye pendant, Louis Vuitton-branded square sunglasses and black padded slides.



LOOK 3 · SWIRL PRINT

Short-sleeve native set in a purple, green and gold swirl print on black, with a striped cap, evil-eye pendant and Ferragamo-branded loafers.



LOOK 4 · DOTTED PRINT

Brown and green dotted-print native set, leather flat cap, dark sunglasses and Prada-branded chunky black sandals.



LOOK 5 · GREEN SET

Light-green native set with beaded chest detail and a striped green cap and Louis Vuitton-branded chunky black patent shoes.



LOOK 6 · BLUE SET

Bright blue native set with a blue embroidered cap, Louis Vuitton-branded square sunglasses and Ferragamo-branded loafers.

CHAPTER TWO

Loud Fonts, Quiet Realities

Big letters on the chest, a calm face above them

The shirt speaks first and I answer later. This chapter is graphic tees, colour blocks and lettering, worn with plain shorts, flat caps and slides.



LOOK 7 · BLACK GRAPHIC TEE

Black oversized graphic tee, wide faded-denim shorts, Converse-branded olive slides, evil-eye pendant, Louis Vuitton-branded square sunglasses and a leather flat cap.



LOOK 8 · COLOUR BLOCK

Tommy Hilfiger-branded red, white and aqua colour-block tee, Gucci-branded black cross-body bag, light trousers with white lettering, Tommy Hilfiger-branded red-striped slides, washed cap.



LOOK 9 · CREAM SET

Cream tee embroidered with dice, stars and the word 'casino', cream shorts with a side stripe, Lacoste-branded red slides.



LOOK 10 · WHITE TEE, GREEN BAG

Gucci-branded white embroidered tee, Lacoste-branded green cross-body bag with cream stripes, light printed jeans, customised Nike Air Force 1 sneakers with monogram-pattern panels and orange laces.



LOOK 11 · PATTERN-BAND POLO

Gucci-branded cream zip polo with a wide patterned band, light jeans covered in printed labels and drawings, Gucci-branded patterned slides, sunglasses and a washed cap.



LOOK 12 · RED GRAPHIC TEE

Red sleeveless graphic tee with "Funds Feeling" lettering, blue denim shorts with black patch pockets, grey five-panel cap, Lacoste-branded red slides.

CHAPTER THREE

Heavy Indigo

Denim piled at the ankle, a small eye at the neck

Heavy cloth and soft colour. This chapter is denim in every wash, stacked at the ankle or cut raw at the edge, with plaid, rhinestone patterns and an evil-eye pendant that keeps coming back.



LOOK 13 · BLACK DENIM SET

Black denim shirt and shorts with raw edges, leather flat cap, Ray-Ban Ferrari-branded round sunglasses, Skechers-branded black slides.



LOOK 14 · STUDDED PLAID, STACKED DENIM

Brown plaid shirt with a rhinestone pattern, faded stacked jeans with buckle straps, leather cap.



LOOK 15 · WOVEN JACKET

Short-sleeve jacket with woven lettering over a black tee, the same stacked jeans, grey cap, dark sunglasses.



LOOK 16 · NAVY PLAID

Navy plaid shirt worn open, faded wide denim shorts, evil-eye pendant, grey cap, Kito-branded navy strap sandals.



LOOK 17 · GREY PATTERN SET

Short-sleeve zip shirt and shorts in a grey and navy pattern, washed cap, red jewelled belt, black padded slides.



LOOK 18 · RHINESTONE PLAID

Brown plaid shirt with a rhinestone monogram pattern, light denim shorts, evil-eye pendant, Ray-Ban Ferrari-branded round sunglasses, leather cap and Skechers-branded black slides.



LOOK 19 · BLUE PLAID, PINK TANK

Blue plaid flannel shirt worn open over a pink tank, grey patchwork jeans, a grey houndstooth flat cap and Lacoste-branded red slides.

Notes and credits

Photography. The cover and Look 1 (yellow lace) were photographed by Tynemoore. Looks 6, 9, 10 and 11 were photographed by the author's wife. Looks 8, 15, 17 and 18 were taken by the author on a timer. The remaining photographs were taken by the author's brother, Samuel, and by friends.

Tailoring. The yellow lace buba and kembe was made by the author's father at Mayor Fashion Center.

Styling. Temitope Israel Balogun styled every look.

Places. All photographs were taken in Ibadan.

Garments. Prints, lettering and labels on clothing belong to their makers. Brand names in the captions are given by the author, and no brand has supplied, endorsed or approved this book.

Privacy. The photographs in this PDF have had their location data removed.

About the author

Temitope Israel Balogun is a Founder & Tech-Archivist based in Ibadan, Nigeria. By day, he preserves history through digital genealogy and the mapping of Yoruba lineage. By night, his work moves from the digital cloud to the physical pavement under the creative name ilefoastro.

For Balogun, style is an active archive. His design approach treats textiles like data sets, balancing the celebratory history of traditional native lace with the weight of global street culture. Whether organizing data or organizing an outfit, his goal is the same: to keep the identity of the past while building toward the future.

He is the author of books on Yoruba lineage and digital genealogy.

ILEFO: Anti-Gravity
ASTRO: Dark Matter
THE ORBIT: Collision

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